

Proctor Cheat Sheet — HMF Design Clinic

Score each use case /100 · ~50 products + ~50 reasoning · 4 = 400 total. Score the reasoning, not an exact product match. Reward answers specific to Cedarline.

90–100 Expert — right products both concerns; reasoning turns on Cedarline's specifics

75–89 Strong — right products; sound reasoning; some generic

50–74 Developing — products mostly right; reasoning thin or one concern weak

25–49 Weak — a category not a product, or restates the problem

1–24 Minimal — off-topic / vague · 0 = blank

1 AI Security

DETECTION & UNKNOWN THREATS

C1 *Unknown / zero-day; 4-day dwell; nothing to match.*

PRODUCTS Cisco Secure Firewall (Snort 3) + Encrypted Visibility Engine · Secure Network Analytics (Stealthwatch) · Cisco XDR · Hypershield · Talos / Secure Malware Analytics

FULL MARKS Behavioural / ML / anomaly detection catches unknown attacks with no signature; XDR correlates telemetry to cut the 4-day dwell to minutes.

C2 *Encrypted traffic = blind spot; decryption banned by Compliance.*

PRODUCTS Encrypted Visibility Engine (EVE) on Secure Firewall · Encrypted Traffic Analytics (ETA) via Secure Network Analytics

FULL MARKS Detect threats INSIDE encrypted traffic without decrypting — keeps visibility, respects the compliance ban, avoids the performance cost.

2 Cloud Edge

MULTICLOUD POSTURE

C1 *AWS + Azure + GCP; different constructs; policy means different things.*

PRODUCTS Cisco Multicloud Defense · Cisco Defense Orchestrator (CDO) · Secure Firewall (virtual / cloud-native)

FULL MARKS One policy model authored once, pushed to each cloud's native constructs — same intent everywhere, one workflow not three.

C2 *Nobody can report posture across all three clouds.*

PRODUCTS Cisco Multicloud Defense visibility · Cisco XDR / Security Cloud Control

FULL MARKS Single dashboard reports posture across AWS, Azure and GCP together — the exact gap Cedarline named.

3 DC Edge · Perimeter Firewall

ESTATE COMPLEXITY

C1 *Too complex to manage; mixed vendor; 3 consoles; weeks-long backlog.*

PRODUCTS Cisco Defense Orchestrator (CDO) + Secure Firewall Management Center · Secure Firewall · Firewall Migration Tool

FULL MARKS Collapse 3 consoles to one management plane — cuts backlog and manual error; sustainable for a 2-engineer team.

C2 *Inherited rulebase nobody can prove; knowledge in 2 heads.*

PRODUCTS CDO rule analysis / hit-counts · Cisco AI Assistant for Security · Migration Tool rule analysis

FULL MARKS Hit counters + AI rule analysis show what each rule does and retire dead ones safely — de-risks the 2-person dependency.

4 Macro & Micro Segmentation

EAST-WEST CONTROL

C1 *Flat DC; any workload reaches any other; no east-west control.*

PRODUCTS Cisco Secure Workload (Tetration) · Cisco Hypershield · Secure Firewall (macro-seg)

FULL MARKS Secure Workload auto-discovers app dependencies and GENERATES micro-seg policy (no 10k hand-written rules); Hypershield enforces in-kernel (eBPF).

C2 *Lateral movement; segmentation died 3× on ~10,000 manual rules.*

PRODUCTS Cisco Secure Workload (automated policy lifecycle) · Cisco Hypershield (autonomous, self-updating)

FULL MARKS Automation replaces the manual rule-writing that killed it 3×, and contains lateral movement by default.